Heavy Equipment Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1926.600)

For site walks before and during work with construction machinery, mechanized equipment and vehicles.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.600

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. Record each defect and correct it before the affected work continues.
3. The manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.600: Equipment (Part 1926 Subpart O: Motor Vehicles, Mechanized Equipment, and Marine Operations) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-600-equipment

SECTION A | Parked and unattended equipment

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Unattended equipment marking Ref. 1926.600(a)(1)	At night, beside a highway in use or near active work, unattended machines show working lights or reflectors, or stand behind barricades carrying them.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Parking brake Ref. 1926.600(a)(3)(ii)	Brake applied on every parked machine.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Wheel chocks on slopes Ref. 1926.600(a)(3)(ii)	Machines parked on an incline have chocks at the wheels and the brake applied.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Blades, buckets and dump bodies Ref. 1926.600(a)(3)(i)	Fully down on the ground or blocked whenever the machine is idle or under repair.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Maintenance, tires, batteries and cab

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
5	Raised machinery blocked Ref. 1926.600(a)(3)(i)	Anything held up by slings, hoists or jacks is blocked or cribbed before anyone goes under or between it.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Controls during repair Ref. 1926.600(a)(3)(i)	Controls in neutral, motor off and brakes on, unless the task needs otherwise.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Tire cage Ref. 1926.600(a)(2)	Tire rack, cage or equivalent in use for inflating, mounting or dismounting split-rim or locking-ring tires.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Batteries Ref. 1926.600(a)(4)	Battery use, care and charging follow 29 CFR 1926 Subpart K.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Cab glass Ref. 1926.600(a)(5)	Safety glass or equivalent fitted, with no visible distortion that affects safe operation.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION C | Power lines						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
10	Overhead wires treated as live Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(vi)	Every overhead wire treated as energized unless the owner or utility has confirmed it is not and it is visibly grounded.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Clearance at 50 kV or below Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(i)	Every part of the crane and load stays at least 10 feet from the lines.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Clearance over 50 kV Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(ii)	Distance set at 10 feet plus 0.4 inch per kV above 50 kV, or twice the insulator length, and never under 10 feet.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Clearance in transit Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(iii)	With no load and boom lowered: at least 4 feet under 50 kV, 10 feet above 50 kV to 345 kV inclusive, 16 feet to 750 kV inclusive.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Clearance observer Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(iv)	A designated person watches clearance and warns the operator wherever it is hard to judge by sight.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Transmitter towers and rail spurs						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
15	Transmitter de-energized or tested Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(vii)	Before work near a transmitter tower, the transmitter is off or a test for induced charge on the crane has been done.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Boom structure grounded Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(vii)(A)	Where induced voltage must be dissipated, a ground runs directly to the upper rotating structure supporting the boom.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Ground jumper cables Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(vii)(B)	Jumper cables attached to materials handled by the boom when a charge is induced.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Nonconductive poles Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(vii)(B)	Crew has nonconductive poles with large alligator clips or similar for attaching the ground cable to the load.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Combustibles cleared Ref. 1926.600(a)(6)(vii)(C)	No combustible or flammable materials in the immediate area when operations start.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Rail spur derails Ref. 1926.600(a)(7)	Derail and/or bumper blocks in place where a rolling car could reach cars being worked, a building, or a work or traffic area.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.